The five hindrances to practice and their remedies:

1) Sensual desire or greed: Desire becomes a hindrance when we want something and grasp for it, then when we get it, cling to it. It could be either harmful to us or inappropriate or not useful at this time.

Remedy: Mindful attention is always appropriate. Work with the RAIN formula previously described (Recognize, Accept, Investigate, Non-identification). Let it come and go without grasping or clinging.

2) Ill-will or aversion: Aversion is wanting things not to be the way they are, forcefully pushing them away. Ill-will is wishing harm to someone or something that is in the way of us getting what we want. It can escalate to anger and intense hatred.

Remedy: RAIN can also be helpful. As with any hindrance, seeing clearly and exploring the aversion or ill-well is useful. Broaden or narrow your focus. For example, broaden to a purposeful loving-kindness practice, or narrow to focus on the breath.

3) Sloth and torpor: Sloth and torpor refer to heaviness in the body and dullness in the mind, lack of clarity. This includes drowsiness, sluggishness, low energy, sleepiness and lethargy. Sloth refers to the physical aspect, such as difficult holding oneself up and falling asleep. Torpor refers to the mental aspects such as difficulty paying attention. Both can be either pleasant or unpleasant.

Remedies: Sit up straight, Take a few deep breaths (count breaths), open your eyes, look at a light, change posture, stand, change mental focus

4) Restlessness & anxiety/worry: Restlessness is a feeling of agitation or over-excitement, it agitates the mind, so it doesn't have the time to see fully. Restlessness is unpleasant, so there is a tendency of the mind to push it away, to not want it there. The mind is restless, and restlessness is further enhanced by struggling against it. Worry is fear of what may happen in the future. Anxiety is a non-specific fear of what will happen in the future.

Remedies: Again, apply RAIN and be mindful of the feelings, transform them into the object of meditation. Try to stay with it and experience it without getting caught up in the content of its story, don't push it away. Don't resist it. Don't be in a rush to get rid of it. You can also use concentration by counting your breaths, until the mind comes back to balance. Concentration cultivates calm and tranquility.

5) Doubt: It is said that doubt is the most dangerous of the hindrances, as it is the one that can cause you to give up your practice. Doubt can be questions about our ability to practice "Can I do this?" or doubt of the practice or the teachings themselves "Is this the right way?". It's a state of indecision that doesn't allow us to fully apply ourselves or see clearly because it interferes with the process.

Remedies: Apply RAIN. Learn to recognize and label doubt as such when it arises, and to put it aside when you meditate. You can work with this hindrance outside practice by gathering clear instructions, talking with teachers and other practitioners to address your questions, and purposefully suspending doubt until you have tested the practice for yourself.